

ZIMBABWE

FEBRUARY 2015 – JULY 2026

Prepared by Africa INSIGHTS Research Team | Vertical: Travel & Tourism

Zimbabwe scores 68/100 on tourism perception for February 2015 – July 2026 — strongly positive.

1,186	68%	14%	18%	68/100
RECORDS IN VIEW	POSITIVE	NEUTRAL	NEGATIVE	PERCEPTION

01 MONTH IN REVIEW

Across 1,186 records of Zimbabwe in February 2015 – July 2026, tourism perception scores **68 out of 100**, on net sentiment of +50 points. The mix reads as strongly positive: 68% of mentions are positive, 14% neutral and 18% negative.

The score is carried by scenery (+82 net across 356 mentions), transport (+49 net across 35 mentions) and food (+39 net across 18 mentions).

Direction of travel is improving: perception moved from 42 in 2015 to 66 in 2026, a change of +24 points. The priority for the period is consolidating the themes that already work and widening coverage on those that are too thinly evidenced to act on.

DATA NOTE

5 themes fall below the 15-mention floor and are excluded from the headline findings: water, weather, electricity, housing, cost.

DATA NOTE

Only one visitor cohort clears the 50-record threshold, so cohorts cannot be compared against each other in this view.

02 PERCEPTION OVERVIEW

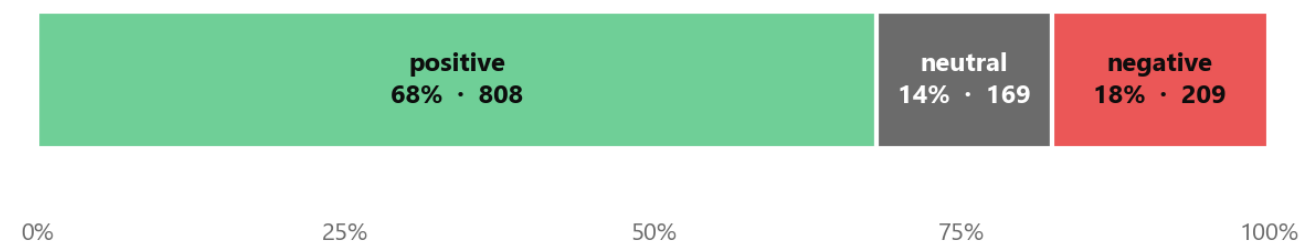
On the 0–100 perception scale, where 50 is neutral, Zimbabwe scores **68**. That is built from 808 positive, 169 neutral and 209 negative records, giving net sentiment of +50 points (68% positive against 18% negative).

The reading is drawn from 1,185 YouTube comments and 1 YouTube transcript segment. 90% of these were attributed to Zimbabwe from what the text is about rather than the query that surfaced them.

Beyond neutral, **excited** is the dominant emotional register, tagged on 402 records (34% of the view). Messaging that answers that register will land harder than messaging that ignores it.

Figure 1 — Sentiment breakdown

How the 1,186 records in view split across sentiment classes. Net sentiment is +50 points.



03 THEMATIC ANALYSIS

Visitors are most positive about scenery (+82 net across 356 mentions), transport (+49 net across 35 mentions) and food (+39 net across 18 mentions). These are the themes with earned credibility: they should lead the campaign, not compete with it.

No theme is decisively negative; the coolest reception goes to safety (+17 net across 23 mentions) and hospitality (+23 net across 128 mentions), which is where to watch next.

Scenery is the most discussed theme overall, raised in 356 mentions with 90% of them positive.

The most-engaged critical mention, from @realityDUBSTEP in Aug 2024, carries 5,248 likes — a single comment with that reach shapes the impression of readers who never see the aggregate.

Voices behind the numbers

The most-engaged supportive and critical mentions in this view. Emoji and non-Latin characters are stripped for print.

POSITIVE · @johnajah4752 · Mar 2022 · 959 likes · score +0.82

"I am Nigerian and seriously looking forward to visiting Zimbabwe maybe with family or students on excursion one day.....Love your guys Zimbabweans"

POSITIVE · @Lsgworx · Jul 2022 · 846 likes · score +0.70

"Im South African and I can tell you that Zimbabwe has the most hard working and intelligent people, also very kind"

NEGATIVE · @realityDUBSTEP · Aug 2024 · 5,248 likes · score -0.85

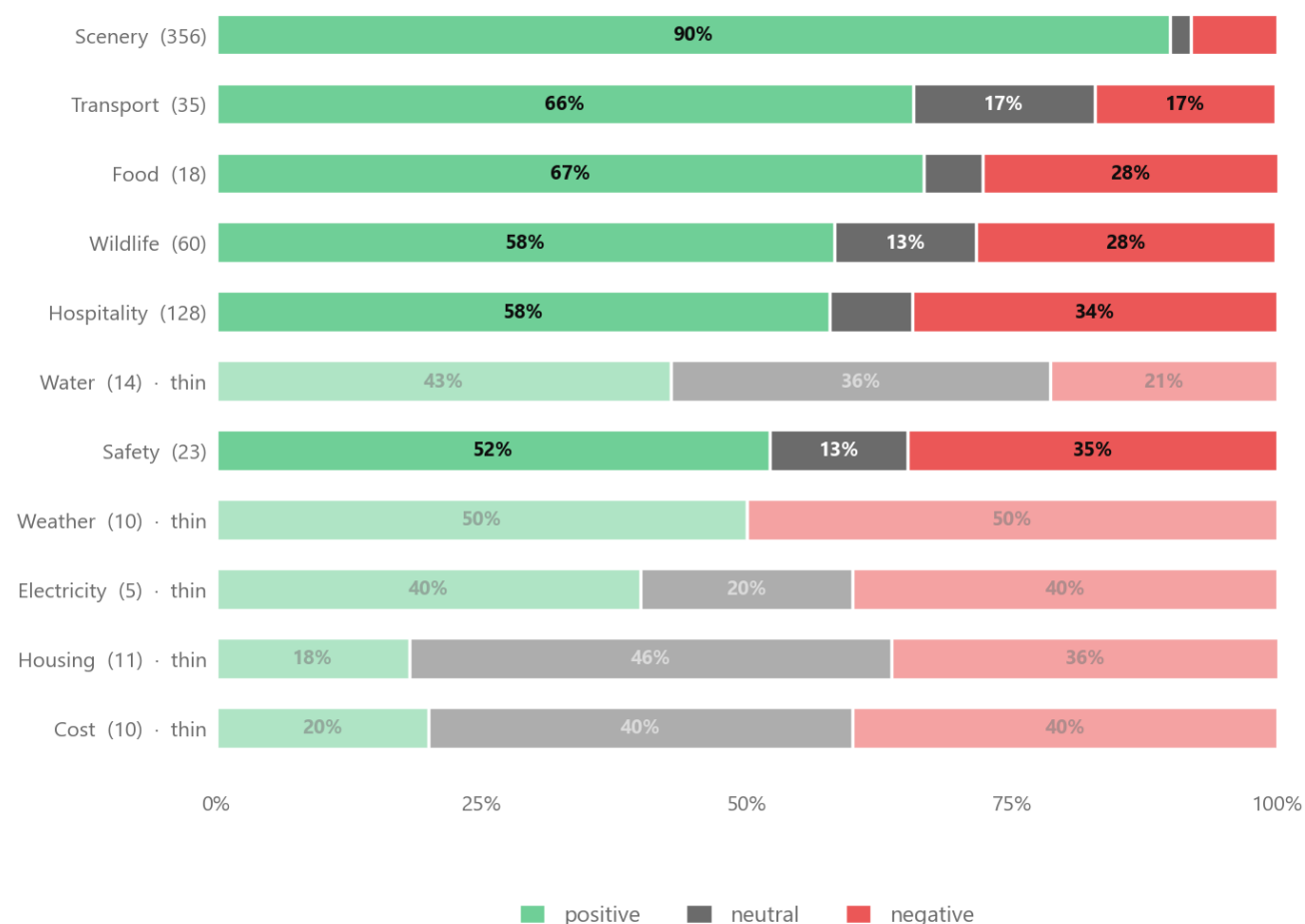
"How can poverty exist in Zimbabwe if everyone is a trillionaire?"

NEGATIVE · @groovedive1 · Aug 2024 · 3,299 likes · score -0.83

"I wonder if in 30 years someone as yourself will be visiting England and wondering why it has become a forgotten ghost town."

Figure 2 — Sentiment by theme

Every travel theme mentioned in this view, ranked by net sentiment. Mention counts in brackets; themes below the 15-mention floor are faded and marked thin.



04 VISITOR SEGMENTS

8% of records name a travel style — most often adventure (74 records), budget (6 records) and business (6 records). The remainder carry no style signal and are left unclassified rather than guessed at.

No two cohorts clear the reliability threshold, so no cohort comparison is made here. Widening segment coverage is the prerequisite for segment-level targeting.

VISITOR SEGMENT	RECORDS	SHARE OF VIEW	PERCEPTION	NET
Adventure	74	6.2%	65/100	+34
Budget · thin	6	0.5%	40/100	-33
Business · thin	6	0.5%	67/100	+50
Luxury · thin	3	0.3%	32/100	-33

05 COMPETITIVE BENCHMARKING

Against the 10 markets in the reference set that clear the reliability threshold, Zimbabwe ranks **6 of 10** on perception at 68 out of 100.

Measured against the peer set, its clearest advantages are transport (+50 points) and safety (+22 points). An advantage that peers do not share is the cheapest thing to advertise.

MARKET	RECORDS	PERCEPTION	NET SENTIMENT
Tanzania	1,326	73/100	+59
Ghana	1,094	70/100	+52
Rwanda	1,526	70/100	+54
Senegal	1,114	70/100	+50
Kenya	2,075	69/100	+52
Zimbabwe	1,186	68/100	+50
South Africa	2,164	65/100	+39
Egypt	2,305	64/100	+36
Nigeria	1,884	62/100	+33
Morocco	52	39/100	-21

06 TRENDS & SIGNALS

Perception is improving across the period, moving from 42 in 2015 to 66 in 2026 (+24 points). Conversation volume peaked in 2025 at 272 records, which is the window worth studying for what moved the needle.

Criticism is rising on hospitality (+6 points of negative share between the first and second half of the period). A worsening theme costs more to fix the longer it runs; this is the intervention to fund now.

Figure 3 — Perception over time (by year)

Perception score per period on a 0–100 scale, where 50 is neutral.

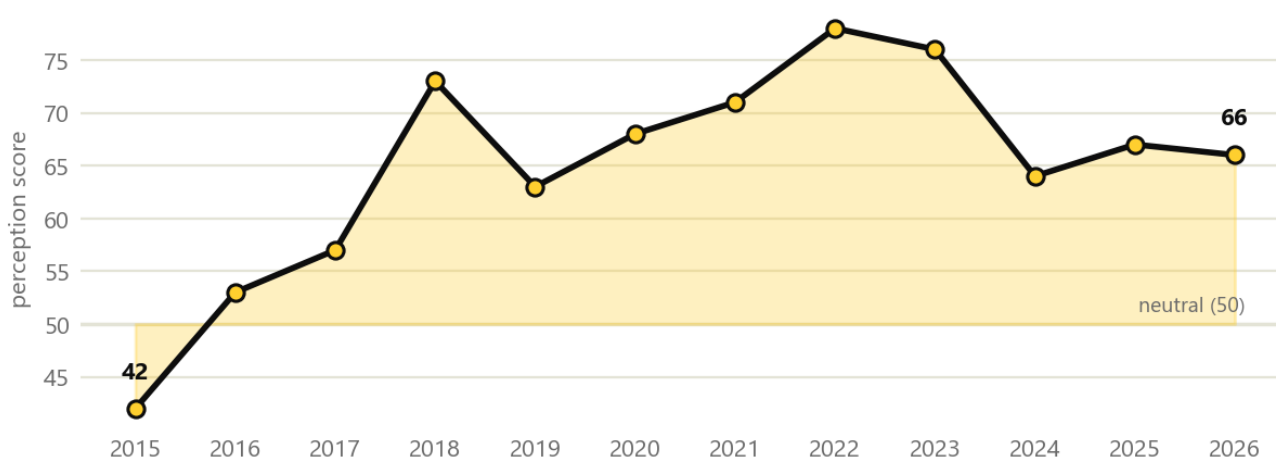
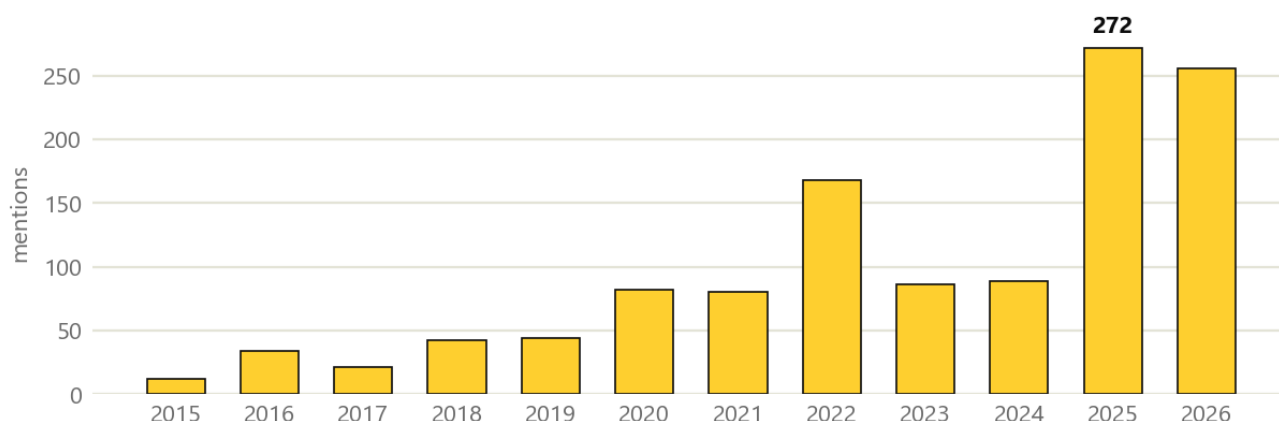


Figure 4 — Conversation volume (by year)

Records per period. Read the trend above against this: a swing on thin volume is noise.



07 RECOMMENDATIONS

Put safety on watch. Nothing is decisively criticised this period, but at +17 net across 23 mentions it is the coolest reception of any well-evidenced theme. Track it monthly; a theme is cheapest to fix before it turns negative.

Lead the next campaign with scenery. At +82 net across 356 mentions it is the most credible claim available, and credibility is what paid media cannot buy.

Treat hospitality as the emerging risk. Negative share rose +6 points across the period. Put it on the monthly watch list and set a review date rather than waiting for the next report.

Set the target against Tanzania, not against last period. Zimbabwe ranks 6 of 10 on perception, 5 points behind the leader at 73 out of 100. That gap, not the month-on-month move, is what a visitor choosing between destinations actually sees.

08 METHODOLOGY & PROVENANCE

Country	Zimbabwe
Year range	2015–2026
Aspect (any of)	all aspects
Sentiment	positive, neutral, negative
Data source	all
Relevant records only	yes
Period	February 2015 – July 2026
Records	1,186
Generated	17 Aug 2026 21:23 UTC
Narrative	Deterministic summary (no language model was available).

Evidence base: 1,185 YouTube comments, 1 YouTube transcript segment. 90% of records were attributed to this market from what the text itself is about rather than from the query that surfaced them. Sentiment is scored by a multilingual transformer; themes, emotion and visitor segment are rule-based taggers. Evidence thresholds: 50 records for a reliable view, 15 mentions before a theme can headline a finding, 5 points before a theme counts as praised or criticised, 10 points before a cross-country gap is stated. Every figure in this report is computed from the filtered records by the analysis pipeline. The written analysis interprets those figures; each number it states is verified back against them before publication, and any section that fails verification is replaced by the deterministic summary.